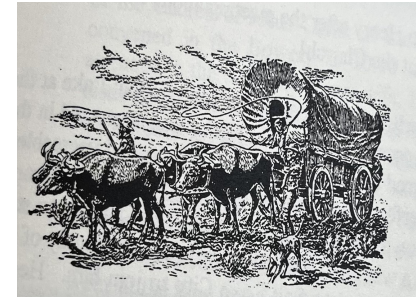




MARY ANN WILSON LUNT

Her shoes wore out and she was wearing moccasins purchased from the Indians when she arrived in Salt Lake City after coming from England and crossing the plains.



CHAPTER XIV

BACK TO CEDAR FORT 1857

Returned missionaries were required to report their mission to the proper authorities in Salt Lake City, Utah before they were released. Henry fulfilled this assignment after arriving back in Utah when he had an interview with President Young. Henry recorded the following in his journal:

Sunday, September 27, 1857: I was the first of the returned missionaries to be called upon to speak. At the close of the meeting Brother Woodruff invited me to go and dine with him. Arrapine, the Utah Chief, also accompanied us. Brother Woodruff took me through his orchard which was well stocked with a great variety of fruit trees which were loaded so heavy that many of them had to be supported with props.

September 29: Sister Mary Ann Wilson came to see me and we had a very pleasant and agreeable interview. I have divined a noble spirit of integrity, faith and virtue in Sister Wilson which has manifested itself in her walk and conversation ever since I first became acquainted with her, which was in June 1856, in Carlisle, England (when she expressed her

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satisfaction to Henry after the meeting about what he had said about the Church].

The Deseret Territorial Fair was taking place in Salt Lake at the time the emigration companies arrived. Henry was interested in the exhibit of manufactured articles, livestock and fruits and vegetables. The Brass Band performed regularly which, according to Henry, "rendered the occasion quite lively and cheerful." He planned to stay in Salt Lake City for a while and notified his wife and her family of his arrival home. They traveled to Salt Lake City to join him. Henry wrote the following in his journal about the time he spent there:

October 3, 1857: I ate supper in company with Sister Wilson at Sister Bathsheba Smith's, a wife of Apostle George A. Smith. His wife, Zilpha, from Parowan was with us and I made her a present of a woolen scarf shawl for her many acts of kindness to me while in Parowan.

October 4: Attended meeting at the Bowery in company with Miss Wilson and we were invited to dine with Brother William Jennings and family where we had a most sumptuous and elegant dinner.

October 5: My father-in-law, Brother James Whittaker, arrived from Cedar City, Iron County, with my beloved wife, Ellen. He came with a light-covered wagon and a yoke of oxen and made the journey, 280 miles, in the extraordinary short space of time of nine days. We were both glad to see each other. Especially were Ellen and I pleased to see each other's faces again in the flesh after an absence of three and a half years. Our feelings can be better imagined than described. The unspeakable pleasure I enjoyed in my wife and father and with my brethren and sisters in Salt Lake on my return seemed to more than repay me for my long absence.

October 6: The Semiannual General Conference

of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints convened in the Bowery at 10:00 a.m., which I attended in the company of my wife, her father and Sister Mary Ann Wilson, both morning and afternoon.

October 7: Attended conference again and, at the close of the morning's meeting, I asked President Young if I could have the privilege of having a young woman sealed to me. He said, 'Come to my office with her in about one hour's time.' Accordingly, I went at the time mentioned with my wife, Ellen, and her father and Sister Wilson to President Young's office and he conducted us upstairs into a very nice room and sealed Mary Ann Wilson to me for 'time and all eternity.' I thanked him and gave him five dollars which he accepted. He then took my hand in both of his and made me a present of the same five dollars and said, 'God bless you.' I thanked the Lord our Heavenly Father for giving me another of his handmaidens to wife, and I pray that we may both prove faithful and true to our God and each other and keep sacred the solemn covenants which we have made, and have peace, love and union always abide in our habitation and children to grow up 'round our table like olive branches that shall become mighty for the truth's sake in the Kingdom of our God. Conference closed in the afternoon.

October 8: President Young sealed Miss Catherine Winchester, late of Bristol, to Father Whittaker. The following two days we spent in visiting a number of our old friends, including President Brigham Young and family with whom we ate supper. They treated us to peaches and grapes and gave us some to eat on our way home.

October 11: We bid adieu to Salt Lake City and started on our way for Cedar City in Iron County where we arrived all safe on the 27th [2 weeks and 3

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days]. We were greeted with a hearty welcome by our many old friends. Brother James Haslam, Captain of the Brass Band, with his brethren serenaded us in the evening with music and stayed until a late hour.

Mary Ann Wilson's oldest daughter, Henrietta Lunt Jones, wrote the majority of the following thoughts about her mother's background before she met Henry Lunt:¹

Mary Ann Wilson, daughter of William and Martha Phillips Wilson, was born in Carlisle, Cumberland, England, January 19, 1834. At the age of three years, her mother died on January 20, 1837, but Mary Ann remembered her as being a lovely woman. As young as she was, she realized the great loss when she looked up at her tall handsome father and noticed the sad expression on his face. He was wearing a band of black crepe on his hat apparently to indicate being in mourning. After her mother died, Mary Ann went to live with her Grandmother Wilson who took good care of her and gave her every advantage of learning and culture. She attended kindergarten when she was four years old. She could read the Bible at the age of six, and she had learned how to sew and knit at a very early age.

Mary Ann's father took her on long walks in the meadows where, no doubt, he would go to meditate over the loss of his wife. Mary Ann slipped and fell in the mud on one of these walks and she never forgot how badly she felt when she saw her little white stockings and slippers all dirty. Her father carried her back home where her grandmother soon had her immaculate again. She had beautiful, long auburn hair. One day on her way home from school she heard footsteps behind her and, when she looked back, a man with a pair of scissors was about to cut off her braids. She quickly avoided him.

Mary Ann became a member of the Church of England and attended church regularly with her grandmother. Mary Ann was required to listen to the preacher so attentively that she could relate almost everything to her grandmother when her grandmother wasn't able to go. Lord Wharton presented a Bible to Mary Ann when she was 12 years old because she was able to repeat from memory the catechism of the Church of England, as well as some of the prayers

and the 1st, 15th, 25th, 37th, 101st, 113th, and 145th Psalms. She received an education qualifying her to become a Governess at the age of 17 and lived with the family of a gentleman where she spent her leisure time hemming frills for fancy shirts. Later, she supported herself by teaching in a day school in Carlisle.

Mary Ann was gifted with a beautiful singing voice and she was chosen as a soloist in the Church of England Choir. On several occasions she was asked to sing for Queen Victoria whom she always admired for her many noble qualities. Mary Ann was loved and respected by everyone who knew her.

In June 1856 when Mary Ann was 22 years old, some of her friends invited her to attend a conference of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints. Her friends told her there was a young missionary from America who would tell of the restored gospel, and being interested and anxious to learn something different from the regular routine of the Church of England, Mary Ann went, but without telling her father and grandmother. When she saw the missionary, Henry Lunt, and heard him talk, she thought, "He is the type of a man I would like for my husband." He was tall and good looking with dark hair and large brown eyes, and he was dressed like an English gentleman. As Mary Ann investigated the new doctrine, she became more interested in the handsome man who had appeared so suddenly in her life, as well as the Gospel, which she felt was true.

When Mary Ann was baptized, the minister of her church who had doted on her, preached her funeral sermon saying, "Another sheep has been lost from the fold." Her friends and the relatives of the royal family who had often invited her to accompany them to church, now passed her by with a look of scorn. When she sold her belongings, she moved to the L.D.S. Headquarters where she used her sewing skills to make and repair shirts for the Elders. She also assisted the saints who were preparing to leave for Utah. While staying there, the landlady of the mission headquarters put five dollars among the papers on the table. Mary Ann was cleaning up and found the money which she promptly returned to the landlady who said she put it there as a test of Mary Ann's honesty.

The group of saints Mary Ann sailed with when she left for

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America was on the ocean for six weeks, and she was so seasick that she wished the ship would sink. Elder Lunt put her in the charge of Brother and Sister Swindle who agreed to furnish her a passage over the plains. They proved to be true and faithful to her and spoke in the highest terms of her as being a most amiable young woman and very industrious and agreeable company, doing all in her power to make them comfortable. Elder Lunt loaned Mary Ann two pounds and ten shillings to pay for her railway fare through the States as she had only four pounds and ten shillings left after she had paid all her debts. She traveled across the plains in Jesse B. Martin's Company. Three days after they had started on their journey, a stampede occurred among the oxen, and wagons were broken and cattle were lost. Two people, an old man and a child, were killed. This crippled the company and only the necessities could be taken on. Good sets of books, feather beds, stoves and items of every description were left on the plains, and every able-bodied person was required to walk. Mary Ann walked the entire distance with the exception of about thirty miles when the Captain of the company allowed her to ride his horse "a few hours one day." Her shoes wore out and she was wearing moccasins purchased from the Indians when she arrived in Salt Lake City. Mary Ann soon found work with a family there. Her company reached the Salt Lake Valley a month before the arrival of Henry's company.

1. Henrietta Lunt Jones, "Father's Life," (1920), p. 49.

Note: The foregoing chapter was taken from a small red book, "A Brief Sketch of Father's Life," written by Henry Lunt's oldest child, Henrietta. Extracts were also taken from an account of Henry's mission written by him while in England. This is not to be confused with the diary he kept during the settling of Cedar City. Both diaries were copied in 1955 by Brigham Young University from the original. The two volumes covered the period between December 7, 1850 and Sept. 1859. Maude Matheson, a daughter of Henry and Mary Ann, wrote: "But for Aunt Ellen Whittaker giving the diary of Henry Lunt to my sister, Ellen Gower, in Mexico, and her having it in her possession and bringing it back to Utah, it would have been destroyed, together with his biography and other books and papers of value, when the Rebel Army set fire to the Lunt home in Pacheco." The original Henry Lunt diary is now in the possession of Paul Lunt in Cedar City, Utah (Copy in the file of York F. Jones). It was secured through William Marvin Lunt, son of Heaton Lunt. Heaton is the son of Sarah Ann Lunt, Henry's fourth wife.

